

Side-effects of technology

Technology is invading our lives faster than we can handle it. This over-indulgence with technology is hurting us dearly. We list some medical ailments associated with technology overload, serious psychological and physiological changes affecting our well-being because of our over-indulgence and inability to control our exposure to technology. For your benefit, it's good to know about these common technology-related ailments to be on your guard against their onset.

RSI: Repetitive stress injury or RSI is like an umbrella term for all ailments originating due to excessive stress applied on a certain part of the body. The sustained pressure focused on the body part can temporarily impair a joint (which has soft tissues, bones, ligaments, muscles, etc.) and the nerves concentrated in that region. If preventive action (generally, a positive ergonomic lifestyle change) isn't taken, it only aggravates the injury further.

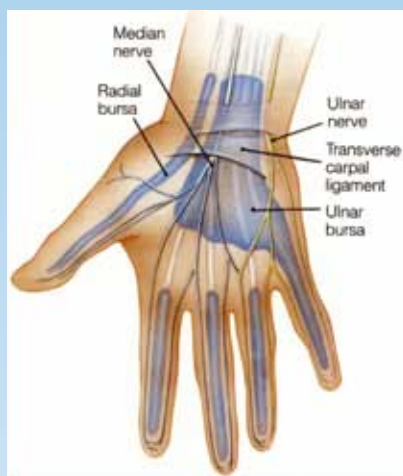
Computer Vision Syndrome (CVS): This is a temporary eye condition that occurs when you focus your vision on a computer (or



Computer

television) screen excessively for a very long time, without taking breaks or looking away. FPS gamers squinting hard to focus on their enemies, finance guys staring at exhaustive spreadsheets with millions of numbers, there are plenty of scenarios that can induce CVS. Symptoms include headaches, trouble re-focusing on other objects, blurred vision and drying of the eyes (because we forget to blink).

Carpal tunnel syndrome: Carpal tunnel syndrome is a form of RSI, where the median nerve responsible for detecting feel and sensation for part of our hand is unduly stressed due



Carpal

to incessant pressure. As the nerve enters your hand from the wrist, the gap through which it enters is narrow and continuous pressure on the wrist can inflame the median nerve. This is very common in people who type on their keyboards excessively without breaks, guitarists, people who hold the needle and sew a lot, and even painters.



Compulsive

Compulsive Communicating: You may deny it, but a constant urge to share on social networks, checking your email inbox incessantly, or your phone's notification window like your life depended on it has been medically certified as a serious side-effect of technology

addiction. The main culprit for this is your latest internet-connected smartphone, according to researchers in UK. American psychologists have gone as far as to say that our brain activity, monitored while subjects responded to their phone buzz, suggests we've started 'loving' our phones. We're completely hooked and it's totally unhealthy.

Text neck: Chiropractors in UK have warned the rise in number of people complaining about pain in their neck. Medical experts suggest they suffer from 'text neck', a side-effect of the increasing amount of time people spend hunched over their smartphone screens. If preventive measures aren't taken against 'text neck', it can invite permanent arthritic damage.

Short-term memory loss: Are you great at multitasking in this age of technology? Well, we have some not so great news to report, unfortunately. Being a multi-tasker can come at a price, one where you're severely reducing your short-term memory retention. Studies conducted in the US are linking extreme multitasking with the brain's ability to store and retain memory for posterity. Yikes! 

